Additional HTML Elements: HTML Fieldset and Legend Tag

Estimated time needed: 15 minutes

Special HTML Elements

In this section, you will explore two tags found within the `<form>` tag, namely the **`<fieldset>`** and **`<legend>`** tags.

Objectives

After completing this reading section, you will be able to:

1. Use the **`<fieldset>`** tag appropriately in HTML pages
2. Use the **`<legend>`** tag to decorate your fieldset

HTML fieldset tag

- The HTML **`<fieldset>`** tag is found within the **`<form>`** tag and is used to group related elements in an HTML form, often by enclosing them within a box.
- There is no restriction to the kind of elements that can be inside a fieldset, but they are mostly used to group related input type of elements, as shown in the example below.
- The fieldset element is especially useful in large forms, where readability and ease of access can be improved with segmentation. Browsers will most likely render a frame around the grouped controls.

Syntax

`<fieldset>` Contents… `</fieldset>`

Attributes

1. **disabled**: It specifies that the elements belonging to the fieldset should be disabled.
2. **form**: It specifies the id of the form that the fieldset is to be considered a part of.
3. **name**: It specifies the name for the fieldset.

Example

In the first example we will create a form with two fieldsets separating personal and professional details:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
    <body>
        <h1>The fieldset element</h1>
        <form>
            <fieldset name="personal_details">
                <label for="fname">First name:</label>
                <input type="text" id="fname" name="fname"><br>
                <label for="lname">Last name:</label>
                <input type="text" id="lname" name="lname"><br>
                <label for="email">Email:</label>
                <input type="email" id="email" name="email"><br>
                <label for="phone">Phone Number:</label>
                <input type="tel" id="phone" name="phone"><br>
            </fieldset>
            <br>

            <fieldset name="professional_details">
                <label for="occupation">Occupation:</label>
                <input type="text" id="occupation" name="occupation"><br>
                <label for="company">Company:</label>
                <input type="text" id="company" name="company"><br>
                <label for="start">Start Date:</label>
                <input type="date" id="start" name="start"><br>
                <label for="end">End Date:</label>
                <input type="date" id="end" name="end"><br>
            </fieldset>
```

```
                <br>
                <input type="submit" value="Submit">
            </form>
        </body>
    </html>
```

Output

The fieldset element

First name:
Last name:
Email:
Phone Number:

Occupation:
Company:
Start Date: yyyy-mm-dd
End Date: yyyy-mm-dd

Submit

HTML legend tag

A **fieldset** can additionally have a title or name, which can be provided by **legend**.
The `<legend>` tag is used with the `<fieldset>` element as a first child (the first inner tag) to define the caption for the grouped related fields
By using the `<legend>` tag with `<fieldset>` elements, it is easy to understand the purpose of grouped form elements.

Example

To understand the `<legend>` tag, let's add this tag to the above example and see the output:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
```

```
<html>
    <body>
        <h1>The fieldset element</h1>
        <form>
            <fieldset name="personal_details">
                <legend>Personal Details</legend>
                <label for="fname">First name:</label>
                <input type="text" id="fname" name="fname"><br>
                <label for="lname">Last name:</label>
                <input type="text" id="lname" name="lname"><br>
                <label for="email">Email:</label>
                <input type="email" id="email" name="email"><br>
                <label for="phone">Phone Number:</label>
                <input type="tel" id="phone" name="phone"><br>
            </fieldset>
            <br>
            <fieldset name="professional_details">
                <legend>Professional Details</legend>
                <label for="occupation">Occupation:</label>
                <input type="text" id="occupation" name="occupation"><br>
                <label for="company">Company:</label>
                <input type="text" id="company" name="company"><br>
                <label for="start">Start Date:</label>
                <input type="date" id="start" name="start"><br>
                <label for="end">End Date:</label>
                <input type="date" id="end" name="end"><br>
            </fieldset>
            <br>
            <input type="submit" value="Submit">
        </form>
    </body>
</html>
```

Output

The fieldset element

Personal Details

First name:

Last name:

Email:

Phone Number:

Professional Details

Occupation:

Company:

Start Date: yyyy-mm-dd

End Date: yyyy-mm-dd

Submit

Congratulations! You have completed the exercise.

Author(s)

Sourabh Mohan

Michelle Saltoun

Skills Network